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ot all players are measured by their numbers on the pitch. For someone like Enzo Fernandez, the influence extends beyond metrics.

Despite his club, Chelsea, struggling for consistency this season amid changes at the helm, Fernandez has been a constant in the middle of the park, fighting for every ball, delivering crunching tackles and riling up opponents from time to time.

A natural-born leader, one will often find him at loggerheads with the opposition or even officials, underlining what is colloquially referred to as the 'dog mentality', which has been pivotal in Argentina's recent success.

He has played the most minutes for Chelsea in the league this season, and an advanced role has helped him bag nine goals and three assists. With Argentina, though, he is expected to sit deeper behind Rodrigo De Paul and Alexis Mac Allister, but the latter duo's modest form in the lead-up to the tournament leaves Fernandez with the responsibility of pulling the strings.

Fernandez had just three appearances for La Albiceleste before the 2022 World Cup in Qatar and ended up walking away with the Best Young Player of the Tournament award, which in turn facilitated his high-value move to London.

This time around, as new transfer rumours surface, Fernandez enters the tournament as a battle-hardened player and the backbone of Lionel Scaloni's team, which is eager to defend its crown.

ARGENTINA

Age - 25

Club - Chelsea

NT Appearances - 40

Goals - 6

Assists - 6



Enzo Fernandez